



Half-Life 2, the best game of the year 2004

November 16: Half-Life 2

Finally! After waiting five years, fans were treated to the sequel of the extremely popular 1999 game Half-Life. Gordon Freeman (the character one plays) returned on November 16, 2004 in Half-Life 2. We don't think we need to tell you any details about what this game involves, and if you haven't played it, what are you sitting around reading this for? Go play it—this book can wait! Half-Life 2 (HL2) was such a success that it won over 35 “Game of the year” awards in 2004. Need we say more?

November 24: WoW!

Plans to make the game World of Warcraft were announced in September 2001, but the game was finally released to the online world on this day in 2004. In the first few months after the launch, this MMORPG (massively multiplayer online role playing game) became so popular that the servers were soon overloaded. Despite being a paid service, the game has over 9 million monthly subscribers today, and is by far the most popular MMORPG of all time.

December 8: The Lenovo deal

IBM, which was at one point in time the world's largest PC manufacturer, announced that it would sell off its personal computing division to Chinese firm Lenovo. The price for buying IBM's PC division was fixed at \$1.75 billion (about Rs 7,000 crore). For Lenovo, which was already China's largest PC manufacturer, this meant being propelled straight into being the world's third largest PC manufacturer.